Deviations Register — Online Examination Portal

Course: UE24CS341A — Software Engineering, PES University, Dept. of CSE
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Version: 1.1 · **Date:** 2026-11-01 · **Covers:** Sprint 1 (19–23 Oct 2026) and Sprint 2 (26 Oct – 1 Nov 2026)

1. Purpose

The Sprint Plan requires every departure from the SRS, SAD, Test Plan or Sprint Plan to be recorded here: what changed, why, and which requirement it affects. Each entry names the pull request or issue where the decision is visible in the repository history. Requirement and test-case IDs are the ones used in `Documents/SRS.pdf` and `Documents/Test_Plan.pdf`.

2. Summary

ID	Date	Baseline document	Affects	Kind	Status
D-01	22 Oct	SRS	FR-004, UT_014	Requirement interpretation	Accepted
D-02	22 Oct	SRS	FR-010, FR-023, NFR-010, UT_030	Design	Accepted
D-03	23 Oct	Sprint Plan	FR-019, FR-020	Scope moved earlier	Accepted
D-04	23–27 Oct	SRS (Organisational)	NFR-006	Process	Closed with exceptions; corrective action not kept in Sprint 2 (see D-08)
D-05	23–27 Oct	Sprint Plan	12 of 52 Sprint 1 points	Schedule	Resolved 27 Oct
D-06	23 Oct	Sprint Plan	Sprint 1 goal; FR-024, FR-027	Scope	Open; delivered by Sprint 2
D-07	19–27 Oct	Sprint Plan (Definition of Done)	All Sprint 1 test cases	Process	Open; Test Plan to be filled by 30 Oct
D-08	27–30 Oct	SRS (Organisational)	NFR-006	Process	Closed with exceptions; repeats D-04

3. Deviations

D-01 — Course code is unique per semester, not globally

Baseline: FR-004 (SRS) says a duplicate course code is rejected.
Built: a course code is unique within a semester. The same code can be reused in a different semester. The database enforces this with the constraint `course_code_unique_per_semester`.
Why: the SRS and the Test Plan disagree. UT_014 expects the same code to be accepted in another semester, which matches how PES University reuses course codes every year. The team followed the test case.
Affects: FR-004, UT_014.
Recorded in: PR #71 (Komal), merged 22 Oct.

D-02 — Negative marking: toggle per examination, deduction per question

Baseline: FR-010 lists "negative marking (on/off and value)" as an examination policy value.
Built: the examination stores only the on/off switch (`Exam.negative_marking`). The deduction value is stored on each question (`Question.negative_marks`), next to its positive marks.

Why: FR-008 already gives every question its own marks. Keeping the deduction beside them lets a 1-mark and a 4-mark question carry different penalties in one paper. The evaluator applies a question's deduction only when the examination's switch is on, so a single paper can still have negative marking turned off. The SRS's open decision on negative marking (flat deduction of the question's configured negative marks) is unchanged.
Affects: FR-010, FR-023, NFR-010. UT_030 still passes: the switch and a 0.5 deduction persist and read back as set.
Recorded in: PR #74 (Komal), merged 22 Oct.

D-03 — Answer saving delivered one sprint early

Baseline: the Sprint Plan places FR-019 (autosave every response) in Sprint 2.
Built: PR #73 (FR-020, automatic submission) also added the service that saves an answer and its endpoint POST `/api/attempts/<id>/answers`. Each choice is saved the moment it is made.
Why: FR-020 submits the answers held at expiry. Without saved answers, an attempt closed by the timer would always score zero.
Affects: FR-019 (Sprint 2 now adds `marked_for_review` and the 5-second guarantee on top of the existing endpoint), FR-020.
Recorded in: PR #73 (Kshitij), merged 23 Oct.

D-04 — Five pull requests merged without a second member's approval

Baseline: NFR-006 requires every merge to `main` to go through a pull request reviewed by another member. Its acceptance test: no direct commits to `main` after 19 Oct, and every merged PR has a reviewer other than its author.
What happened: there were no direct commits to `main`. Nine of the fourteen pull requests merged since 19 Oct carry an **Approve** review from another member. Five of Kshitij's pull requests were merged with the repository owner's admin override instead:

PR	Item	Review	Merged
#68	FR-022, FR-023 evaluation	Komal commented ("Looks good"), did not approve	23 Oct
#70	FR-015, FR-016 start attempt	Komal commented ("Cool!"), did not approve	23 Oct
#73	FR-020 automatic submission	Komal commented ("Okay"), did not approve	23 Oct
#79	Start exam button on the student exam page	None	27 Oct
#80	Shared stylesheet and role navigation	None	27 Oct

Why: #68, #70 and #73 were stacked (each built on the one before) and blocked the Sprint 1 video due 23 Oct. #79 and #80 were merged before the Sprint 1 review demo on 27 Oct. CI was green on all five, and the full suite (109 tests) passes on `main`.
Corrective action: from Sprint 2 there are no admin merges. Every pull request, including the repository owner's, waits for an **Approve** review from another member; a comment does not count.
Recorded in: issue #38, closed 27 Oct with the full audit.

D-05 — Sprint 1 finished four days late

Baseline: Sprint 1 runs 19–23 Oct with a 52-point commitment.
What happened: 40 points closed by 23 Oct. The remaining 12 points were coded within the sprint but merged on 27 Oct:

Item	Points	Closed by	Cause
FR-006 enrolled-exam visibility	3	PR #75	Review asked for 403 instead of 404 (IT_011) and test IDs
FR-017 server-clock countdown	3	PR #76	Review asked it to reuse the attempt services; merge conflict
FR-029 no answer key in Student payloads	2	PR #76	Same pull request as FR-017
NFR-013 CSRF, ORM-only, generic error pages	2	PR #78	Waiting for review
NFR-014 secrets from environment variables	1	Verified, closed by hand	Waiting on #78

Item	Points	Closed by	Cause
NFR-006 review by another member	1	Issue #38	See D-04

Merge conflicts were the main cause. A teammate's editor reformatted whole files on save (`repository/models.py` in PR #71, `attempts/views.py` in PR #75), so every branch touching those files conflicted. The review also found that the student exam page had no control to start an attempt (FR-006 and FR-015 were built by different members); PR #79 added it on 27 Oct.
Corrective action: members turn off format-on-save for this repository (requested in the review of PR #71), and a branch merges `main` into itself before review so conflicts are resolved by its owner.
Affects: the Sprint 1 burndown, which shows the drop on 27 Oct.

D-06 — The Sprint 1 score is computed but not yet shown to the Student

Baseline: the Sprint 1 goal ends with the Student "receiving an automatically computed score".
Built: every submission is evaluated automatically and its score is stored on the attempt (FR-022, FR-023). No screen shows it yet: the Student scorecard and the Faculty results view belong to FR-024 to FR-027, which the Sprint Plan places in Sprint 2. In the Sprint 1 demo the stored score is read from the database.
Affects: Sprint 1 goal; FR-024, FR-027.
Status: open, delivered by Sprint 2 (30 Oct).

D-07 — Test results recorded in pull requests, not in the Test Plan

Baseline: Definition of Done item 3 requires each item's test cases in `Documents/Test_Plan.pdf` to be executed with their *Actual Result* and *Test Result* columns filled in.
What happened: the test cases were automated and run by CI on every pull request, and each pull request lists its results. The Test Plan's *Actual Result* and *Test Result* columns are still empty. PR #74 names its tests `test_ut028_…` rather than by test-case ID alone, and PR #78 has no results table.
Corrective action: QA & Docs (Komal) fills both columns for every Sprint 1 and Sprint 2 test case from the CI runs before the development freeze on 30 Oct.
Affects: all Sprint 1 test cases; NFR-007 (every FR linked to a test case).

D-08 — Eleven more pull requests merged without a second member's approval

Baseline: NFR-006, and D-04's corrective action: from Sprint 2, every pull request, including the repository owner's, waits for an **Approve** review from another member.
What happened: the corrective action was not kept. After D-04 was recorded on 27 Oct, eleven of Kshitij's pull requests were merged to `main` with the repository owner's admin override. None had an **Approve** from another member when it was merged. The only review on each was GitHub Copilot's automated comment. There were still no direct commits to `main`, and CI passed on all eleven.

PR	Item	Open before merge	Review at merge	Merged
#82	Fix template tags split across lines	Minutes	Copilot comment only	27 Oct
#83	FR-024 total, percentage and Pass / Fail	13 h	Copilot comment only	28 Oct
#84	FR-021 resume an interrupted attempt	13 h	Copilot comment only	28 Oct
#86	Load-test review follow-ups (NFR-001, NFR-003)	1 h	Copilot comment only	28 Oct
#87	SQLite WAL fix; 200-user load test passes (NFR-001, NFR-003)	Minutes	Copilot comment only	28 Oct
#89	Sprint 2 data model (migration 0005, shared test data)	5 h	Copilot comment only; Kartik approved on 31 Oct, after the merge	30 Oct
#90	FR-009 version a question once it is in use	3 h	Copilot comment only	30 Oct
#91	FR-019 autosave, clear and mark for review	3 h	Copilot comment only	30 Oct
#92	NFR-002 evaluate 100 questions within 5 s	3 h	Copilot comment only	30 Oct
#93	NFR-004 service back within 60 s after a restart	3 h	Copilot comment only	30 Oct
#94	NFR-010 policy values configurable per exam	3 h	Copilot comment only	30 Oct

Why:

- **#82** fixed Django template tags that had been split across two lines. Django does not parse such tags, so they showed on the page as raw text. It was merged within minutes of being opened.
- **#86 and #87** were follow-ups to Komal's load-test pull request #85, which had been reviewed and approved. #87 is the fix that made the 200-user load test pass.
- **#83 and #84** were merged the same evening as #86 and #87, after 13 hours with no review.
- **#89 to #94** were merged on 30 Oct, the planned last day of Sprint 2, at the repository owner's direction. Both teammates' Sprint 2 branches build on #89: their tests use its shared test data (`portal.testkit.World`), and its migration adds the tables those features write to. The teammates' branches could not pass CI until #89 was on `main`.

Effect: NFR-006's acceptance test fails for these eleven pull requests. Every other pull request merged in Sprint 2 carries an **Approve** from a member other than its author: #81, #85, #88, #97, #98, #99, #100, #101 and #102.
Note on #99, #101 and #102 (Kartik's, merged 1 Nov): the repository owner resolved their merge conflicts with `main` on Kartik's branches, at the team's request, and then approved them. NFR-006's test is met, because the reviewer is not the pull request's author. However, those conflict-resolution commits were reviewed only by the person who wrote them. Each pull request's review comment lists exactly what was changed.
Corrective action: this replaces D-04's. An admin merge stays possible when waiting would miss a deadline. Each one is recorded in this register on the day it happens, naming the pull request and why it could not wait for an **Approve**.
Recorded in: this register. The pull requests' review histories are the evidence.